M&A / REGULATORY STRATEGY

EU MERGER CONTROL

Regulatory Intelligence & M&A Diligence Strategy

Historical case evidence, review pathways and decision-focused transaction planning

CLIENT DECISION

What should an acquiring company investigate, and when, to make an informed regulatory-risk decision before committing to a transaction in the European Union?

HISTORICAL CASES	REVIEW SIGNAL	ELIGIBLE CLEARANCES
10,376	3.09% Phase II initiation	5.05% conditional clearance

EVIDENCE BASE | European Commission DG Competition merger-case publications · case-level SQL and Python validation · four Power BI executive views

Scope: historical intelligence and a proposed advisory workplan. No transaction-specific legal conclusion, implementation or realised benefit is asserted.

EXECUTIVE BRIEFING

The decision in brief

A compact view of the evidence and the action it supports.

EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

Commission a transaction-specific filing and competition assessment before assuming a standard clearance timetable. Use historical patterns to prioritise diligence, not to predict the outcome of an individual deal.

Three findings that affect execution

EVIDENCE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR MANAGEMENT
Phase II initiated in 309 of 9,993 eligible cases (3.09%).	In-depth review is uncommon in the historical population, but can be material to transaction planning.
Median observed interval: Phase I 31 days; Phase II 173 days.	Create a reviewed timeline scenario and a downside contingency before fixing an unconditional closing plan.
Conditional clearances: 489 of 9,678 eligible cleared cases (5.05%).	Prioritise remedy feasibility where market overlap, evidence or precedents justify further scrutiny.

Immediate actions

01 Validate filing exposure. Ask competition counsel to map jurisdictional filing requirements, parties, turnover and control; do not rely on historical frequencies as legal advice.

02 Establish the competition facts. Assemble target/buyer product overlaps, relevant geographies, market shares and key competitors.

03 Protect transaction optionality. Prepare review-timing scenarios, potential remedy constraints and a documented management decision gate before commitment.

Reporting note: 2026 is a partial reporting year. Comparisons with completed years require caution.

CLIENT MANDATE

Business problem and decision architecture

A hypothetical client considering an acquisition in the European Union.

Business problem

An international acquirer needs to assess whether European merger-control obligations and competition concerns could change its transaction structure, cost, timetable or attractiveness. Historical published decisions can reveal patterns, but do not identify the legal position of a proposed deal.

Management decision question

DECISION QUESTION

How can historical European Commission merger-control data and targeted regulatory due diligence be used to identify potential review risks, assess transaction execution considerations and prioritise the investigations needed to support an informed acquisition decision in the European Union?

Six decision-support measures used in the analysis

MEASURE	PURPOSE
Historical merger case volume	Establish coverage, notified trends and reporting context.
In-depth review rate	Measure recorded Phase II initiation among eligible cases.
Regulatory decision distribution	Understand the composition of observed classified outcomes.
Median regulatory review duration	Compare observed calendar-day intervals by review phase.
Regulatory evidence coverage	Show how many case histories meet the defined evidence standard.
Priority diligence issues (DCES)	Translate findings into transparent, decision-relevant investigation priorities.

Scope boundary

This work assesses published European Commission case records. It is not a filing assessment for an identified buyer or target, a legal opinion, a predictive risk model or an analysis of deal value.

CLIENT DISCOVERY

Questions and information needed to make a decision

Proposed questions for a simulated client. No interviews are represented as having occurred.

Five questions management should answer

01 Strategic objectives. What are the strategic objectives of the acquisition, including relevant products, customers and geographic markets?

02 Competition overlaps. Where do buyer and target compete or participate in vertically linked markets, and what are their market positions?

03 Notification assessment. Which EU or other national competition filing requirements have been identified or verified by legal advisers?

04 Signing and closing. What are the intended signing and closing timetables, and how could extended regulatory review or conditions affect the commercial objectives?

05 Decision tolerance. Which unresolved competition concerns or diligence findings would cause management to reconsider transaction timing, structure or strategic attractiveness?

Two critical information gaps

GAP	WHY IT MATTERS	IMMEDIATE REQUEST
Transaction-specific competitive assessment	The dataset contains no verified buyer/target overlap, market shares, competitive positions or relevant-market analysis for a proposed deal.	Products and geographies, parties, customer/competitor lists, estimates of share and internal market studies.
Filing and execution requirements	No verified filing map, review plan or sufficiently detailed transaction timetable exists for this simulated engagement.	Counsel-led jurisdiction and threshold review; signing/closing plan; regulatory dependencies.

DECISION IMPLICATION

These gaps are gating dependencies. Historical statistics are not a substitute for the transaction facts required to advise on filing obligations or competitive effects.

EVIDENCE BASE

Dataset, provenance and analytical pipeline

Published merger-control records beginning in 1990; the underlying source is not a population of every potential acquisition.

Evidence supplied and reconciled

COMPONENT	GRAIN / SIZE	ANALYTICAL ROLE
Case-level core	10,376 distinct case IDs	Notification, outcome, eligibility and observed timing.
Decision records	11,579 decision events; 10,337 cases with decisions	Historical decision-event activity, not case count.
Sector memberships	16,286 associations; 10,234 cases with sector coverage	Code-level descriptive comparisons, with overlapping memberships.
Phase II pathways	309 recorded initiation case histories	Reconstructed subsequent event pathways and audit flags.
Adjusted model results	2 sector estimates for dashboard presentation	Modelled associations from a separate regression sample.

Reproducible workflow

01 Acquire. Use the Commission merger case JSON and published case metadata; keep the source representation and case identifiers.

02 Flatten and classify. Construct case, decision and sector tables; normalise dates, decision categories and evidence status.

03 Validate. Check unique case IDs, decision-event versus case counts, negative chronology, outliers and KPI eligibility.

04 Analyse. Apply SQL and Python to descriptive KPIs and hypothesis tests; publish four defined Power BI views.

Official context: Commission case-search guidance [1], open-data publication [2] and merger procedures [3]. Full citations are given in Sources.

DATA RELIABILITY

Eligibility, exclusions and quality safeguards

Different valid denominators reflect different analytical questions, not inconsistent arithmetic.

POPULATION	COUNT	WHY NOT ALL CASES?
Core distinct merger cases	10,376	Case-level reference population.
Cases with notification date	10,131	245 lack a usable notification date.
Cases with recorded decisions	10,337	39 have no recorded decision.
Outcome-eligible cases	9,968	408 lack a classifiable eligible outcome.
Phase II rate-eligible cases	9,993	Defined case set used for the recorded initiation indicator.
Timing-eligible cases	9,708	9,471 Phase I plus 237 Phase II; eligibility and selected endpoints required.
Evidence-complete cases	9,886	95.28% of the 10,376-case core.
Cases with a sector association	10,234	142 without published sector association.

Checks materially affecting interpretation

Case identifiers were unique in the supplied core CSV. The dataset includes 97 one-day date discrepancies, one date correction recorded in the analytical file and 21 interval flags over 365 days requiring case-history review. These flags justify explicit eligibility rules; they do not, by themselves, establish substantive case errors.

A case may have several decisions and several sector memberships. Consequently, decision events must not be described as unique cases, and sector memberships must not be summed as mutually exclusive cases.

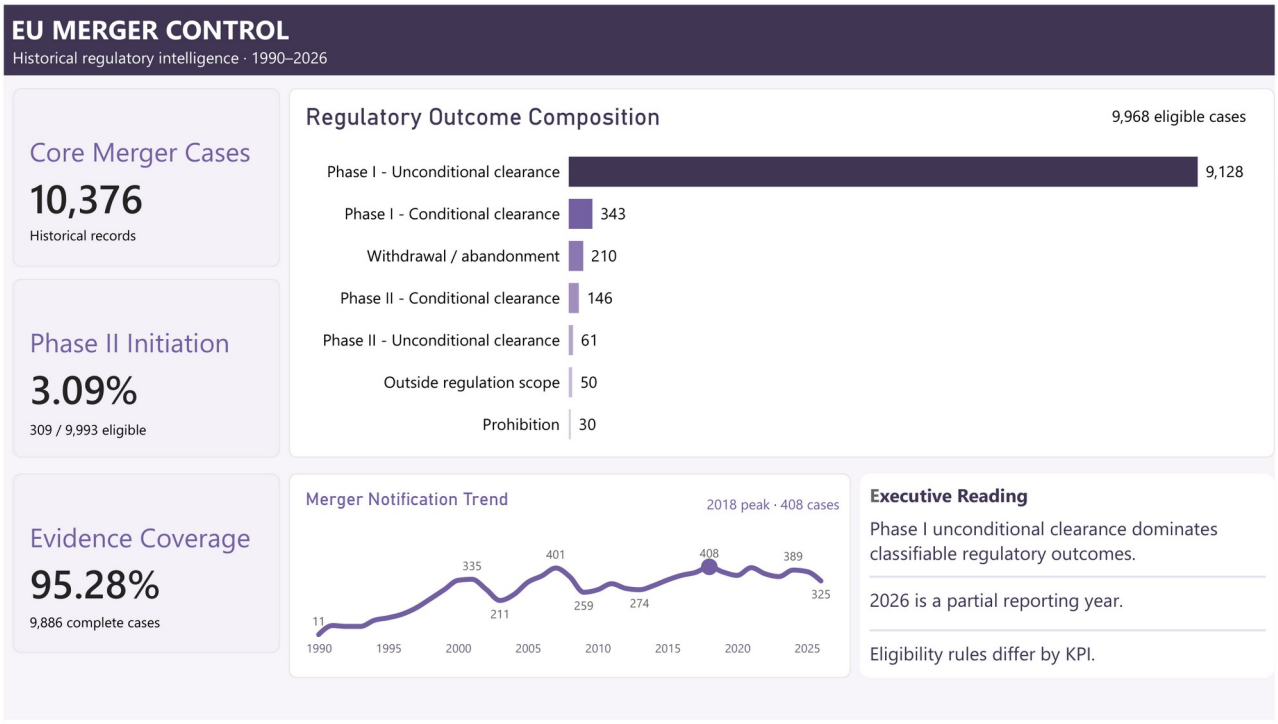
RECONCILIATION RULE

Always label the numerator, denominator, grain and eligibility condition before presenting any percentage or duration. The reported KPI should be traceable to a case-level or event-level definition.

EXECUTIVE EVIDENCE VIEW

Historical merger landscape

The first Power BI view establishes scale, outcome dominance and notification activity.



Power BI view: case volumes, eligibility-sensitive outcome composition and annual notifications. Source: validated case and decision records.

Decision-relevant reading

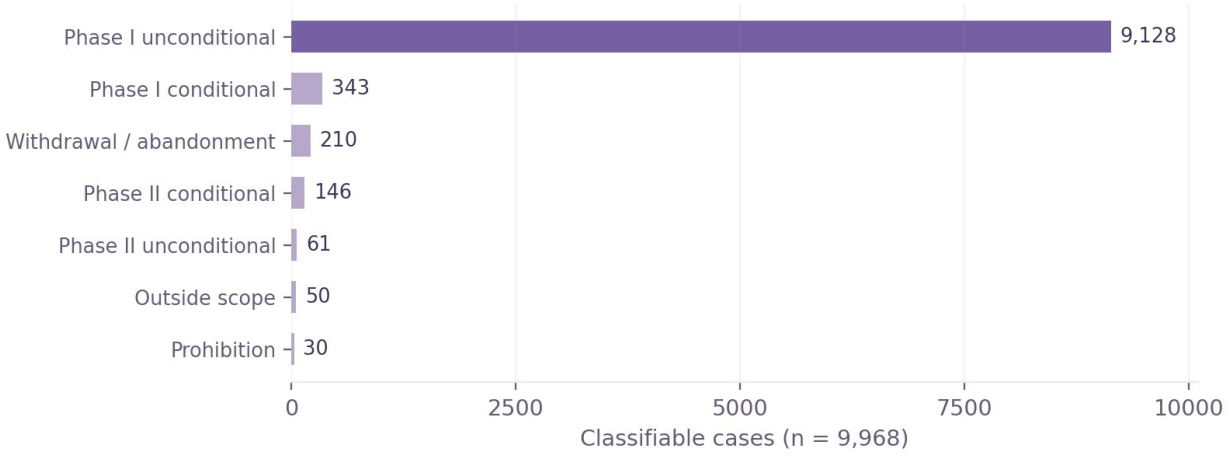
The core contains 10,376 cases. Among 9,968 eligible classifiable cases, 9,128 were Phase I unconditional clearances. The pattern establishes a historical baseline, but the dataset is neither a random sample of potential acquisitions nor a prediction tool for a specific transaction.

The annual notification series peaks at 408 cases in 2018. The 2026 observation is partial and should not be used as a complete-year comparator. Any claimed change in activity should therefore distinguish completed years, changes in the applicable merger regime and publication coverage.

REGULATORY OUTCOMES

What the observed decisions do—and do not—show

A case-level classification of the selected analytical outcome, not an exhaustive account of every legal event.



Classifiable outcomes: 9,968 eligible cases. Bars use the observed case-level categories.

CLASSIFICATION	CASES	MANAGEMENT INTERPRETATION
Phase I unconditional	9,128	Dominant observed category; do not generalise to a proposed deal.
Phase I conditional	343	Signals possible commitments before an in-depth inquiry.
Phase II conditional	146	Signals detailed review and potential remedy negotiations.
Phase II unconditional	61	In-depth scrutiny does not automatically mean conditions.
Withdrawal / abandonment	210	Commercial and procedural reasons require case-specific checking.
Outside regulation scope / prohibition	50 / 30	Legally distinct categories requiring careful interpretation.

CLEARANCE METRIC

489 conditional clearances divided by 9,678 eligible cleared cases = 5.05%. This is a clearance-subset measure, not 489 divided by all published cases.

REVIEW PATHWAYS

Decision records and subsequent case histories

A second Power BI view separates event volumes, case volumes, durations and audit classifications.



Power BI view: 11,579 decision events, 10,337 cases with decisions, 309 recorded Phase II initiations.

What management should take away

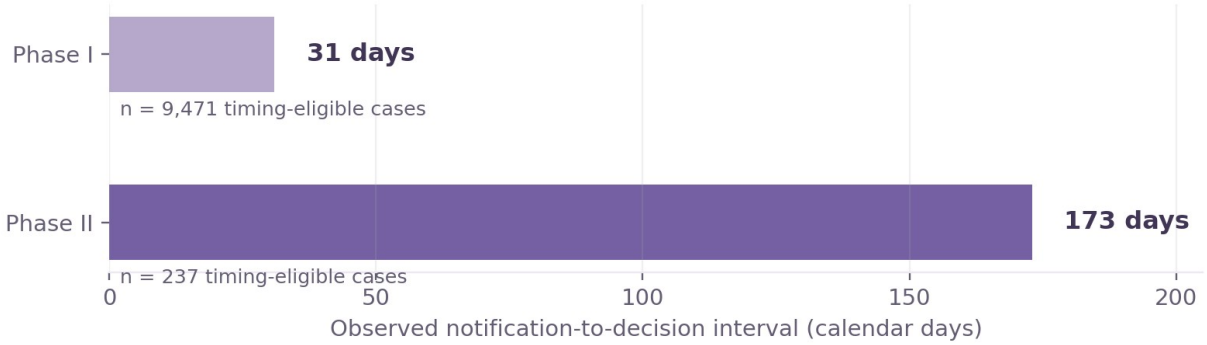
The 309 initiation cases represent 3.09% of the 9,993-case eligible initiation population. Reconstructed subsequent pathways comprise 147 later conditional, 63 later unconditional, 56 withdrawal/abandonment, 30 prohibition and 13 exceptional/review-required histories.

Separately, the pathway audit identifies 296 histories without its specified audit flags and 13 exceptional cases. An unflagged sequence is not the same as an independently legally verified final outcome. The reconstructed 147 later conditional pathways must not be substituted for the stricter 146 case-level Phase II conditional classifications.

REVIEW DURATION / HYPOTHESIS H1

A substantial observed difference in review intervals

This is a comparison of historical distributions and medians, not a claim that Phase II causes a specified delay.



Both medians use the same calendar-day scale; Phase I n=9,471 and Phase II n=237.

TEST COMPONENT	VALIDATED RESULT
Median observed interval	Phase I 31 days; Phase II 173 days
Difference between medians	142 calendar days
Bootstrap 95% CI for median difference	138–151 calendar days
Mann–Whitney U (Phase II as first group)	2,244,455
Two-sided p-value	2.321×10^{-153}
Rank-biserial association	Approximately 0.9998 (Phase II-first convention)

Why this test was used

Mann–Whitney U compares rank distributions without assuming normally distributed timing data. It is suitable for skewed intervals and markedly unequal group sizes. Its p-value indicates a strong distributional difference; the bootstrap interval expresses uncertainty around the median difference. Neither measures a causal treatment effect.

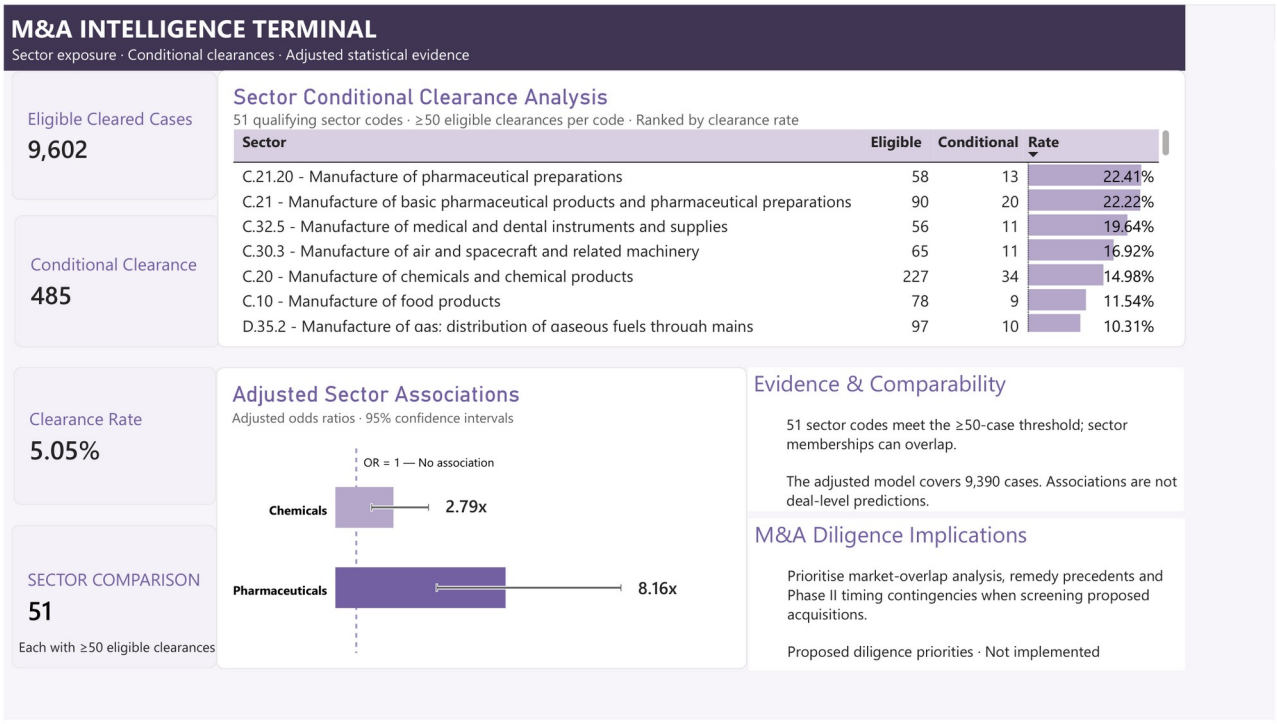
DEAL IMPLICATION

Require an explicit in-depth review scenario in the closing plan, while having counsel calculate any statutory working-day deadlines and procedural suspensions separately.

SECTOR INTELLIGENCE

Conditional-clearance patterns by economic activity

The third Power BI view combines descriptive sector comparisons and adjusted statistical evidence.



Power BI view: 51 sector codes meet the 50 eligible-cleared-case display threshold; adjusted sector models are shown separately.

Scope reconciliation

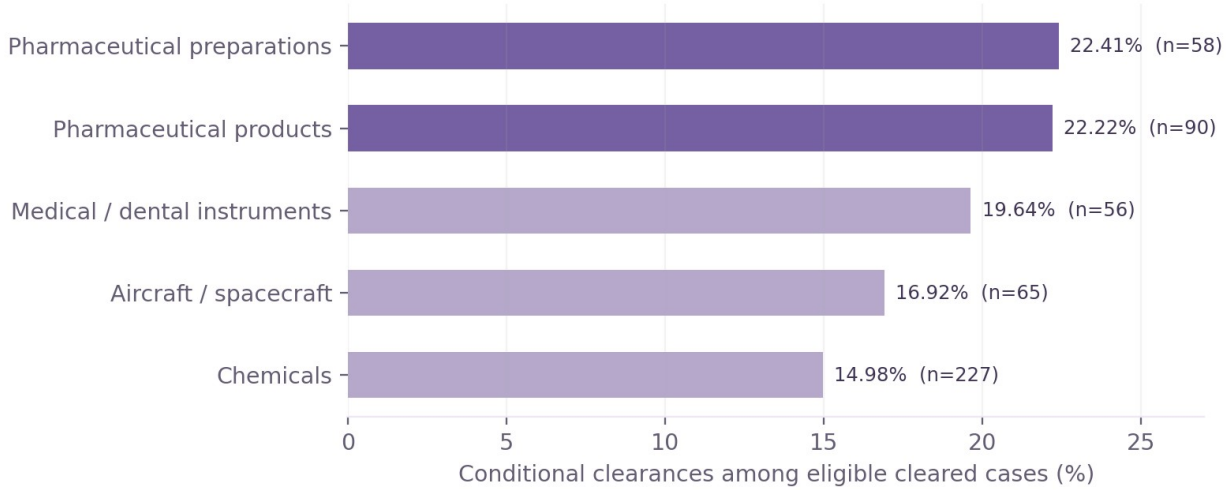
Among cases with sector representation, 9,602 eligible cleared cases include 485 conditional clearances (5.05%). In the 51-code filtered comparison, individual sector rows must be treated as overlapping memberships. Their totals should not be presented as mutually exclusive deal counts.

The threshold of at least 50 eligible clearances per displayed code improves descriptive readability but does not guarantee statistical significance or eliminate selection bias. The supporting eligible and conditional counts should remain next to each rate.

SECTOR COMPARISON

Where deeper competition analysis may be warranted

Sector patterns help direct questions; they do not determine whether a proposed deal needs remedies.



Highest displayed qualifying code-level rates. Error bars are not shown here; these are raw descriptive proportions.

SECTOR CODE GROUP	ELIGIBLE / CONDITIONAL	RATE
Pharmaceutical preparations	58 / 13	22.41%
Basic pharmaceutical products	90 / 20	22.22%
Medical / dental instruments	56 / 11	19.64%
Aircraft / spacecraft	65 / 11	16.92%
Chemicals	227 / 34	14.98%

These code-level figures indicate where a diligence team might examine market definitions, relevant precedents and remedy feasibility. They cannot be ranked as deal-specific clearance risks because the sector codes may overlap and acquisition characteristics vary materially within a code.

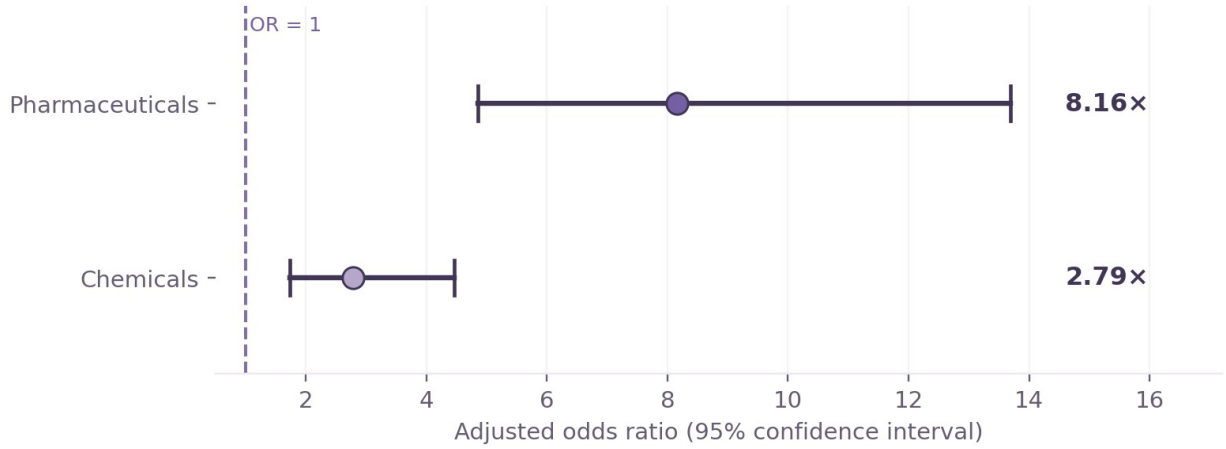
ACTION

When the proposed deal has a relevant sector overlap, commission a focused precedent map covering market structure, theories of harm, outcome type and remedy conditions—not simply the sector average.

MODELLED EVIDENCE / HYPOTHESIS H2

Adjusted sector associations

The adjusted model accounts for measured review-phase and period factors. It helps prioritise further checks, but does not establish causation.



Adjusted odds ratios with 95% confidence intervals. Dashed line at 1 denotes no association.

SECTOR INDICATOR	ADJUSTED ODDS RATIO	95% CI
Chemicals	2.7854	1.7386–4.4623
Pharmaceuticals	8.1585	4.8627–13.6880

The adjusted logistic model used 9,390 cases and included review-phase and historical-period controls. Both displayed associations remained significant after Holm multiple-testing correction in the validated Python results. The sample and modelling definition differ from the descriptive 9,602-case sector-represented cleared population.

An odds ratio of 8.16 does not mean an 816% probability of conditional clearance. It compares modelled odds under the stated controls. Sector coding, overlapping activities, omitted market structure and selection into the model still limit interpretation.

Analyst action

Use these results as a prompt to review current competitive overlaps, Commission precedents and potential remedy feasibility for affected deal markets. Do not turn the regression coefficient directly into a transaction risk score.

HISTORICAL COMPARISONS / HYPOTHESIS H3

Period signals are weaker than transaction facts

The period hypothesis tested whether recorded Phase II initiation patterns varied across historical cohorts.

What the exploratory test supports

Earlier Python analysis indicated a statistically detectable but small period association, with some sensitivity checks reducing confidence in its robustness. The available validated summary does not support a stable transaction-level trend coefficient. We therefore do not use a historical period effect to predict future Phase II initiation for a proposed deal.

Why the evidence is fragile

01 Changing regulation. The dataset spans the earlier merger-control regime and the framework established under Regulation 139/2004. Results should not be assumed directly comparable without controlling for structural changes.

02 Partial and published-case coverage. Public records reflect published notified matters, not the full set of proposed acquisitions; 2026 is an incomplete year.

03 Selection and rarity. Phase II initiations are uncommon and can be sensitive to the choice of denominator, period bands and missing records.

04 Unobserved case facts. Horizontal overlaps, market shares and remedy discussions cannot be reconstructed comprehensively from summary publication metadata.

DECISION RULE

Historical trend signals may inform questions and scenario planning. They should not be used as stand-alone evidence to approve, reject or price a particular acquisition.

Proposed sensitivity checks for any future refresh

Recalculate completed-year cohorts, compare alternative period bands, confirm consistent eligibility definitions and test whether findings persist after accounting for case type and sector composition. Escalate unstable estimates rather than publishing them as definitive forecasts.

DECISION PRIORITISATION

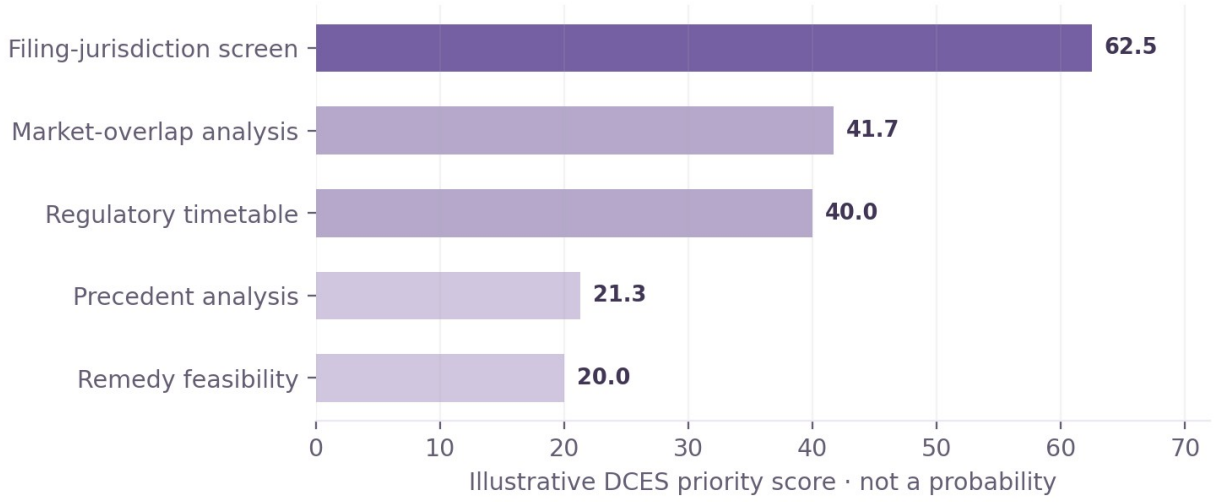
DCES: ranking the investigations that could change a deal decision

A transparent management heuristic, not a validated statistical estimator.

DCES FORMULA

Decision-Changing Evidence Score = (Impact × Uncertainty Reduced × Actionability) ÷ Effort. Every dimension is scored from 1 (low) to 5 (high); higher scores indicate priority for investigation, not an outcome probability.

PROPOSED INVESTIGATION	I	U	A	E	DCES
Filing and jurisdiction screen	5	5	5	2	62.5
Market-overlap assessment	5	5	5	3	41.7
Review-timetable scenarios	4	4	5	2	40.0
Comparable precedent search	4	4	4	3	21.3
Remedy feasibility review	5	4	4	4	20.0



Illustrative priority ranking. Scores are management assumptions to be calibrated with the actual client, not outputs of the DG COMP dataset.

I = importance for the acquisition decision; U = uncertainty the investigation could remove; A = ability to act on the result; E = estimated delivery effort. The model is intentionally simple and should be recalibrated with accountable owners.

Sensitivity: raising the filing screen effort from 2 to 3 reduces its score from 62.5 to 41.7. The second and third priorities are also close (41.7 versus 40.0). Therefore, scores guide discussion rather than impose automatic decisions; legal filing requirements always remain mandatory regardless of ranking.

PROPOSED DILIGENCE PLAN

Practical 90-day roadmap and ownership

Indicative project-management phases, not statutory merger-review timetables.

WHEN	WORKSTREAM / OWNER	DELIVERABLE	MANAGEMENT GATE
Days 0–10	Corporate development + competition counsel: establish transaction facts, parties, control and jurisdictions.	Transaction fact pack; filing screen and evidence request list.	G1: Are filing and pre-signing assumptions credible?
Days 11–30	Competition economists + commercial leads: map relevant markets, overlaps, shares and competitors.	Competition concerns register and market-overlap matrix.	G2: Are any material issues unresolved?
Days 31–60	Counsel + strategy team: test relevant precedent decisions and possible remedies; refresh DCES.	Precedent briefs; remedy feasibility options; updated risks.	G3: Can the proposed structure withstand the identified constraints?
Days 61–90	Transaction PMO + legal + investment committee: build timetable scenarios and conditional action plan.	Regulatory readiness plan; closing dependencies and approval gates.	G4: Approve, revise, pause or escalate for further advice.

Operating rhythm

01 Weekly evidence review. Track outstanding factual requests, source reliability, material uncertainty and decision-sensitive assumptions. Owner: regulatory diligence PMO.

02 Fortnightly steering decision. Challenge changes in sector exposure, remedies and timing; update DCES and the risk register. Owner: corporate development lead.

03 Issue-led escalation. Escalate questions with potential filing, competitive-effect, remedy or closing consequences to qualified competition counsel and the investment committee.

DELIVERY STANDARD

Each proposed investigation must produce an owner, evidence source, written finding, an unresolved-risk flag and a clear management action. No implementation, regulator engagement or transaction outcome is claimed.

REGULATORY GOVERNANCE

Decision gates, contingencies and escalation

Converts findings into options without presenting historical averages as forecasts.

GATE	EVIDENCE REQUIRED	PROPOSED DECISION
G1 — Jurisdiction	Ownership/control, turnover facts, draft filing analysis, counsel sign-off.	Proceed with detailed planning or commission additional filings advice.
G2 — Competition exposure	Market definitions, overlaps, market shares, documents, competitors and customers.	Decide where specialist economic assessment is needed.
G3 — Remedy feasibility	Precedents, structural/behavioural options, feasibility and commercial cost estimates.	Revise the perimeter, prepare options or escalate to investment committee.
G4 — Execution readiness	Regulatory timetable scenarios, approvals, contractual conditions and financing dependencies.	Proceed under documented conditions, defer or reconsider the deal.

Three scenario tracks to prepare

01 Baseline regulatory path. Manage the filing analysis and likely information requirements; maintain an updated timetable agreed with counsel.

02 In-depth review scenario. Model longer review time, additional evidence requests, financing/closing dependencies and contractual flexibilities.

03 Remedy or restructuring scenario. Test whether acceptable commitments or transaction changes are operationally feasible before assuming they would secure clearance.

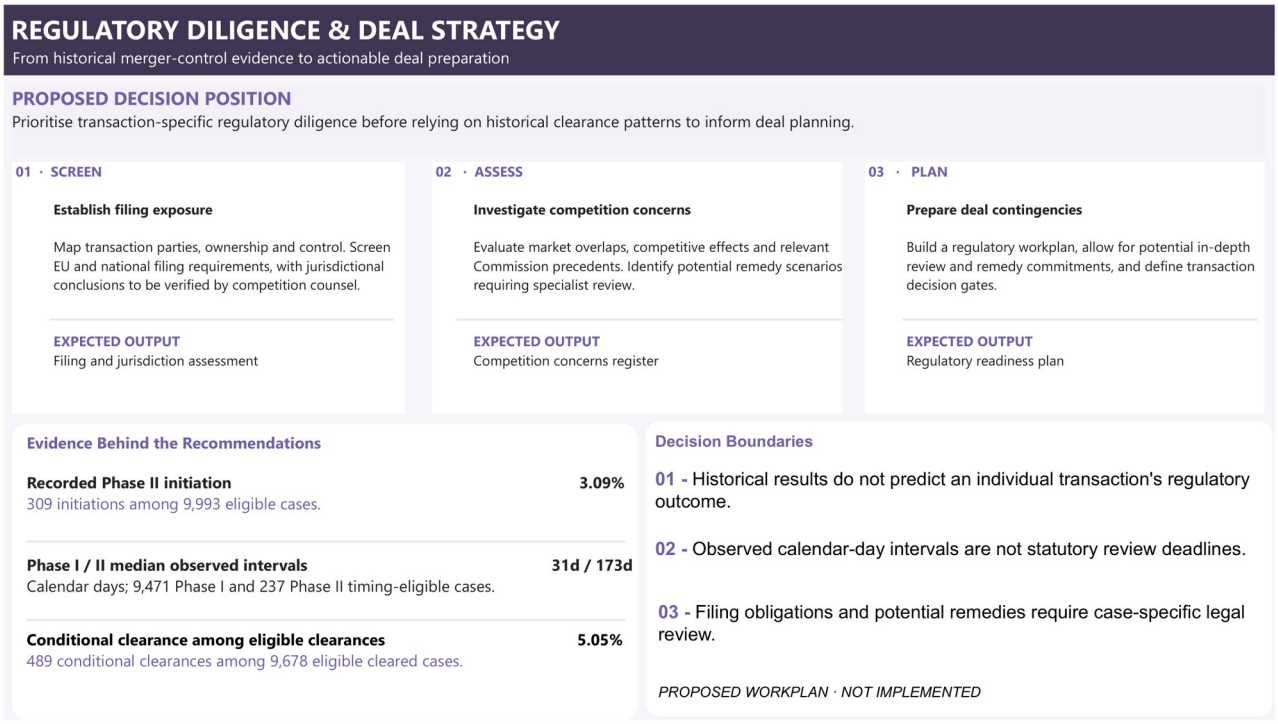
Stop / reconsider signals — proposed

Escalate if market boundaries cannot be established, filing obligations remain uncertain, remedies could undermine the acquisition thesis, or closing dependencies cannot absorb a defensible regulatory timetable. These are governance triggers proposed for management, not legal thresholds.

MANAGEMENT DASHBOARD

Regulatory diligence and deal strategy

The final Power BI view consolidates evidence into a proposed Screen → Assess → Plan workplan.



Power BI view: proposed filing screen, competition assessment, deal contingencies and decision boundaries.

How the evidence informs the workstreams

The historical 3.09% Phase II initiation share suggests in-depth review is not the dominant published pathway, but it cannot eliminate the need for a transaction-specific competition screen. Median intervals of 31 and 173 calendar days justify contrasting timing scenarios, not statutory deadline assumptions. The overall 5.05% conditional-clearance rate supports remedy due diligence where specific overlaps warrant it.

MANAGEMENT DECISION

Use the Screen → Assess → Plan workstreams to resolve filing and competition uncertainties, stress-test review timing and document decision gates. This is a proposed workplan; no client implementation has occurred.

LIMITS AND ASSURANCE

Limitations, caveats and what must be verified

The strength of the decision depends on the match between the evidence and the transaction.

LIMITATION	IMPLICATION / MITIGATION
Published-case selection	Not all potential, abandoned or unnotified acquisitions are present. Avoid clearance-probability claims.
Partial 2026	Treat 2026 as an incomplete reporting period; compare completed years separately.
Different eligibility populations	Show numerator, denominator and case grain for each KPI; do not sum sector memberships.
Reconstructed outcomes	Later event pathways are not synonymous with independently verified final legal outcomes.
Interval definitions	Observed notification-to-selected-decision calendar days are not working-day statutory clocks.
Statistical assumptions	Mann–Whitney confirms distributional differences; regression ORs show associations, not effects.
Client information missing	Obtain case-specific filing facts, market definition, market shares, documents and timetable.

Quality assurance status

The visual PDF was checked against the supplied core case data and validated analysis. The Power BI relationship configuration was reviewed at case_id grain. This report does not assert an independent end-to-end certification of all PBIX DAX expressions, interactive filter behaviour or official legal case files.

What a decision-maker should ask next

Which filing obligations are confirmed by counsel? Which market overlaps are commercially material? What possible remedies would change the deal economics or strategic thesis? What closing dependencies are exposed under an in-depth review? Which unresolved issue would change the investment committee decision?

TECHNICAL APPENDIX

KPI definitions, calculations and model controls

Reference definitions retained for auditability without crowding the main report.

KPI / CALCULATION	DEFINITION / VALIDATED VALUE
Core cases	10,376 distinct case IDs in the validated core dataset (equivalent to DISTINCTCOUNT(case_id)).
Notified cases	Count with usable notification date = 10,131; 2018 highest annual count = 408.
Phase II initiation rate	309 ÷ 9,993 eligible = 3.09%.
Outcome classification coverage	9,968 eligible out of 10,376 core cases.
Evidence coverage	9,886 evidence-complete ÷ 10,376 = 95.28%.
Decision records	11,579 event rows across 10,337 distinct cases.
Timing medians	MEDIAN(analytical_interval_days) for timing-eligible: Phase I n=9,471 median 31, Phase II n=237 median 173.
Overall conditional clearance rate	(343 Phase I conditional + 146 Phase II conditional) ÷ (9,128 + 343 + 146 + 61) = 489 / 9,678 = 5.05%.
Sector-represented clearance	485 conditional ÷ 9,602 eligible cleared with sector representation = 5.05%.
Qualifying sectors	51 distinct sector codes with ≥50 eligible clearances; overlapping memberships, not mutually exclusive cases.
DCES	(Impact × Uncertainty Reduced × Actionability) / Effort, with each input 1–5; illustrative, not validated.

Model architecture

The case table connects by case_id to decisions, sectors and Phase II pathways through active one-to-many single-direction relationships. Adjusted regression result rows remain standalone. Sector-level DAX measures apply case membership filters explicitly (TREATAS in the validated design) rather than relying on bidirectional model relationships.

STATISTICAL APPENDIX

Hypothesis tests and inference boundaries

Technical details retained because they influence how strongly each business conclusion can be stated.

H1 — review-phase interval difference

Two-sided Mann–Whitney U with Phase II as the first sample: n(II)=237, n(I)=9,471, U=2,244,455 and $p \approx 2.321 \times 10^{-153}$. The rank-biserial estimate using that group order is approximately +0.9998. Group medians were 173 and 31 calendar days; bootstrap 95% CI for the 142-day median difference was 138–151 days. The test concerns ranks/distributions and should not be described as a causal estimate. Independent audit check: 10,000 within-group percentile-bootstrap resamples (random seed 42) reproduced the 138–151-day interval.

H2 — sector association

Unadjusted comparisons showed heterogeneous sector associations; earlier checks included financial activities OR≈0.503, telecommunications OR≈1.545, chemicals OR≈3.483 and pharmaceuticals OR≈5.555. These are descriptive/unadjusted effects, not substitutes for the controlled model. The adjusted model (n=9,390) reported chemicals OR=2.7854 (95% CI 1.7386–4.4623) and pharmaceuticals OR=8.1585 (4.8627–13.6880), with both displayed indicators surviving Holm correction. Adjustment covered review-phase and historical-period effects; omitted deal-market characteristics remain a limitation.

H3 — historical period differences

The exploratory period test indicated a small association in earlier validated analysis, but sensitivity was not consistently robust. No unsupported chi-square statistic or effect size is substituted here. The appropriate management conclusion is to treat period patterns as historical context and require scenario testing and case-specific evidence before changing a deal decision.

Definitions and checks

For a case-level outcome proportion, cases are counted once within the specified eligible population. For sector-level analysis, a case may contribute to several distinct sector codes; row sums are therefore not case totals. For DCES, all 1–5 scores are analyst assumptions, not values estimated by the logistic regression or merger-control source.

REFERENCES AND EVIDENCE REGISTER

Sources, figure provenance and reporting qualifications

Reference material supporting the legal context, source provenance and reproducibility.

Official sources

1. European Commission — Merger Cases Search user guide
https://competition-policy.ec.europa.eu/mergers/practical-information/cases-search-user-guide_en

2. European data portal — EU Competition: Merger case publications
https://data.europa.eu/data/datasets/cc7e224e-6569-40f0-8037-d3389aa0fae7?locale=en

3. European Commission — Merger procedures, Phase I, Phase II and remedies
https://competition-policy.ec.europa.eu/mergers/procedures_en

4. European Commission — EU merger regulation
https://competition-policy.ec.europa.eu/mergers/legislation/regulation_en

5. EUR-Lex — Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2023/914, consolidated
https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A02023R0914-20241128

6. European Commission — Case search and publicly accessible case records
https://competition-cases.ec.europa.eu/search

Analytical evidence

Dataset: supplied EU merger case JSON (case-data-M.json); validated case-level CSV (cases_core_sql_ready.csv); retained decision-event, sector-association and Phase II pathway counts; Google Colab statistical outputs; four-page Power BI report export (EU Merger verified.pdf).

Analytical assistance disclosure

AI assistance was used for coding support, analytical checks, dashboard development guidance and report drafting. Numerical findings were checked against retained case-level data and validated analytical outputs. This does not replace independent legal verification.

Interpretation guardrails

All commercial workstreams, DCES values, governance gates, owners and delivery windows are proposed illustrations for a hypothetical client. They are not actual engagements, legal advice, implemented process changes, forecasts of clearance, or verified realised benefits.

FINAL MANAGEMENT TAKEAWAY

Use published regulatory evidence to ask better questions, commit resources to the investigations that could change the decision, and create explicit regulatory gates before assuming a deal timetable or negotiating strategy.